



BOOKSMITH — how to use it

you talk · it writes · you get a finished book

What this is. This folder writes your book **with** you. You give it whatever you have (notes, drafts, rambles — or nothing at all) and about **ten minutes of conversation**. It then drafts the whole book **in your voice**, checks its own work at every step, and hands you **upload-ready files** for Kindle, print paperback and hardcover, EPUB stores, and a share-by-email PDF — plus a cover. **Nothing ships until you say so.**

1 Set up once

~10 min, one time per computer

- ☐ Install **Claude Code** (claude.com/claude-code) and **Python 3.10+** (python.org).
- ☐ Open a terminal in this folder and run: `pip install -r requirements.txt`
- ☐ Run the check-up: `python _tools/doctor.py` — it tells you what your computer can do. Green means go. ("Tier 2" just means ebooks now; print PDFs need a Windows computer with Microsoft Word — you can do that part later, anywhere.)

2 Start your book

the whole ritual

- Drop anything you have** into the `intake` folder — notes, Word docs, PDFs, old drafts, transcripts of you talking. Mess and duplicates are fine. **Having nothing is also fine** — it will interview the book out of you.
- Open Claude Code in this folder.**
- Say hi.** Tell it you want to write a book and answer its questions — plain talk, about ten minutes. (Also works: paste `Read START_HERE.m` `d in full and follow it exactly.`) Overwhelmed? Say **"just decide for me"** and it will, out loud.

Before it starts writing, it shows you a **one-page pitch of your book** — the title ideas, who it's for, the shape, a paragraph written the way you sound. **That page is your steering wheel.** Once you approve it, the machine works alone and only interrupts for two things: **chapters you claimed for yourself**, and the final **"ship it?"**

3 Things you can say, anytime

"how's it going"	progress report — chapters done, words, what's next
"keep going"	writes the next chapter(s), updates you as it lands them
"rewrite chapter 3, warmer"	redoes exactly that, keeps every earlier version
"I'll write the dedication myself"	that space stays yours — it will never fill it in
"show me the book so far"	assembles everything into one readable draft
"make the covers"	cover art + lettering for every edition, checked by eye
"ship it"	final pass: every format built, checked, and boxed with upload checklists
"continue"	after closing the app, a crash, anything — picks up exactly where it stopped. Work is saved the moment it's written; nothing is ever lost.

4 Already have a book?

Drop the manuscript (Word, PDF, EPUB, or plain text) into `intake` and say **"make this better."** It reads all of it, asks what you're hoping for, then rewrites the book from the ground up in **your** register — not a light polish, a rebirth. You get a **receipt**: anything it chose to drop is listed for you, so nothing disappears silently. Mark any passage **sacred** and it stays word-for-word.

5 Where your finished book lands

Everything	<code>book_workspace\<your book>\outputs\</code> — one folder per store
Kindle & EPUB	<code>outputs\kindle\</code> · <code>outputs\epub\</code> (Apple, Kobo, Google, Nook)
Print	<code>outputs\kdp_paperback\</code> · <code>kdp_hardcover\</code> · Mixam & Blurb folders
Share-by-email	<code>outputs\digital\</code> — a clean PDF with covers, for friends and reviewers
With each	an upload checklist — follow it line by line on the store's site

Quick fixes. • **No graphics card** for cover art? Put any image you like in the book's `cover_art` folder and say "use this" — the lettering and layout are still done for you. • **Print files** need Windows + Microsoft Word; ebooks don't — finish print on any Word machine later. • **Confused?** Say "status". **Stuck?** Close it, reopen, say "continue".

THE DEAL What to expect

- ☐ **First pass lands at ~90%.** You redline, it revises — quickly. A v1.1 is cheap; a blank page is expensive.
- ☐ **It never invents your life.** What it can't know, it asks. What you didn't decide, it decides out loud and tells you it did — change any of it, anytime.
- ☐ **Your words stay yours.** Chapters you claim are left for you; passages you mark sacred are never touched; every draft version is kept, nothing overwritten.

For the **author**, not the admin — setup details and machine config live in `INSTALL.md` and `docs\`. BOOKSMITH user manual v1.0 · ships with the kit · generated 2026-07-11.